

ROMAN CATHOLIC CANON

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Abstract

Example

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The Bishop of Rome is the successor of Peter, with universal jurisdiction and infallibility when speaking ex cathedra on faith and morals.

Example: Pastor Aeternus (Vatican I, 1870) The Roman Pontiff, when he speaks ex cathedra is possessed of that infallibility with which the divine Redeemer willed that His Church should be endowed. Only two ex cathedra declarations: Immaculate Conception (1854) and Assumption (1950).

0.1 2. Scripture + Tradition

Revelation comes through TWO channels: Sacred Scripture AND Sacred Tradition, interpreted by the Magisterium.

Example: Sola scriptura (Protestant) vs. Scripture + Tradition (Catholic). The canon of Scripture itself was determined by Tradition (councils). The Church does not derive her certainty about all revealed truths from the holy Scriptures alone (Dei Verbum 9).

0.2 3. Seven Sacraments

Grace operates through seven sacramental actions, each instituted by Christ.

Example: Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist, Penance, Anointing of the Sick, Holy Orders, Matrimony. The Protestant Reformation reduced to two (Baptism, Lords Supper). Catholicism maintained all seven as operational channels of grace.

0.3 4. Transubstantiation

In the Eucharist, bread and wine become the actual body and blood of Christ substance changes, accidents remain.

Example: Aristotelian metaphysics applied to sacrament. The bread LOOKS like bread (accidents) but IS Christ (substance). This is the D that Protestantism most sharply rejected.

1. Constraints

MUST: Cite magisterial source (council, encyclical, CCC) for doctrinal claims

MUST: Distinguish dogma from theological opinion

MUST NOT: Present post-Vatican II developments as unchanged tradition

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